

QUESTION_ID: de55ec71

SOURCE_FILE: Boundaries.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 1

SKILL: Boundaries

DIFFICULTY: Easy

QUESTION:

Generations of mystery and horror _____ have been influenced by the dark, gothic stories of celebrated American author Edgar Allan Poe (1809-1849).

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. writers
- B. writers,
- C. writers-
- D. writers;

CORRECT_ANSWER: A

RATIONALE:

Choice A is the best answer. The convention being tested is punctuation between a subject and a verb. When, as in this case, a subject ("Generations of mystery and horror writers") is immediately followed by a verb ("have been influenced"), no punctuation is needed. Choice B is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the subject and the verb. Choice C is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the subject and the verb. Choice D is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the subject and the verb.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: c3397d25

SOURCE_FILE: Boundaries.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 2

SKILL: Boundaries

DIFFICULTY: Medium

QUESTION:

Since the nineteenth century, Egyptologists have commonly divided ancient Egyptian history into three primary _____ Old Kingdom (2700-2200 BCE), the Middle Kingdom (2050-1800 BCE), and the New Kingdom (1550-1100 BCE). Some historians, however, criticize the names of these periods for revealing more about the culture of the mainly European Egyptologists than that of ancient Egypt itself.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. periods. The
- B. periods: the
- C. periods; the
- D. periods, the

CORRECT_ANSWER: B

RATIONALE:

Choice B is the best answer. The convention being tested is punctuation use between a main clause and an enumerated series. In this choice, a colon is correctly used after the main clause ("Since...periods") to introduce the series identifying the three primary periods of ancient Egyptian history.

Choice A is incorrect because placing a period after "periods" results in a rhetorically unacceptable sentence fragment beginning with "the Old Kingdom."

Choice C is incorrect because a semicolon can't be used in this way to introduce a series. A semicolon is conventionally used to join two main clauses or to separate items in a complex series, neither of which is the case here. Choice D is incorrect because a comma is not conventionally used to mark the boundary between the main clause ("Since...periods") and an enumerated series ("the Old Kingdom...(1550-1100 BCE)") that contains internal commas. Using a comma in this way creates ambiguity about which commas separate elements in the series and which mark other boundaries in the sentence, making the colon the best choice.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 89fbc3eb

SOURCE_FILE: Boundaries.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 3

SKILL: Boundaries

DIFFICULTY: Medium

QUESTION:

The Mission 66 initiative, which was approved by Congress in 1956, represented a major investment in the infrastructure of overburdened national _____ it prioritized physical improvements to the parks' roads, utilities, employee housing, and visitor facilities while also establishing educational programming for the public.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. parks and
- B. parks
- C. parks;
- D. parks,

CORRECT_ANSWER: C

RATIONALE:

Choice C is the best answer. The convention being tested is the coordination of main clauses within a sentence. This choice uses a semicolon to correctly join the first main clause ("The Mission...parks") and the second main clause that begins with "it."

Choice A is incorrect. When coordinating two longer main clauses such as these, it's conventional to use a comma before the coordinating conjunction. Choice B is incorrect because it results in a run-on sentence. The two main clauses are fused without punctuation and/or a conjunction. Choice D is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. Without a conjunction following it, a comma can't be used in this way to join two main clauses.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 960dec02

SOURCE_FILE: Boundaries.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 4

SKILL: Boundaries

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

A recent study tracked the number of bee species present in twenty-seven New York apple orchards over a ten-year period. _____ found that when wild growth near an orchard was cleared, the number of different bee species visiting the orchard decreased.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. Entomologist Heather Grab:
- B. Entomologist, Heather Grab,
- C. Entomologist Heather Grab
- D. Entomologist Heather Grab,

CORRECT_ANSWER: C

RATIONALE:

Choice C is the best answer. The convention being tested is punctuation use between a name and title and between a subject and a verb. No punctuation is needed between the proper noun "Heather Grab" and "entomologist," the title that describes Grab. Additionally, no punctuation is needed between the sentence's subject ("Entomologist Heather Grab") and the main verb ("found") that indicates what Grab did.

Choice A is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the subject and the verb. Choice B is incorrect because no punctuation is needed. Setting the entomologist's name off with commas suggests that it could be removed without affecting the coherence of the sentence, which isn't the case. Choice D is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the subject and the verb.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 4b0c7b62

SOURCE_FILE: Boundaries.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 5

SKILL: Boundaries

DIFFICULTY: Easy

QUESTION:

The algaita is a double reed wind instrument from West Africa. The reed of a wind instrument is the mouthpiece _____. A double reed contains two pieces of cane that vibrate and produce sound as air passes between them. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. where sound is made?
- B. where is sound made.
- C. where sound is made.
- D. where is sound made?

CORRECT_ANSWER: C

RATIONALE:

Choice C is the best answer. The convention being tested is end-of-sentence punctuation. This choice correctly uses a period to punctuate a declarative sentence ("the reed of a wind instrument is the mouthpiece") that ends with a prepositional phrase ("where sound is made"). Choice A is incorrect. It's unconventional to use a question mark to punctuate a declarative sentence. Choice B is incorrect. The structure requires that the sentence continue as a declarative clause, not end with an interrogative clause. Choice D is incorrect. The structure requires that the sentence continue as a declarative clause and end with a period, not end with an interrogative clause and a question mark.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 7f226b4b

SOURCE_FILE: Boundaries.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 6

SKILL: Boundaries

DIFFICULTY: Medium

QUESTION:

In a 2023 study, researchers documented a fascinating behavior in the aquatic plant *Elodea densa*. When exposed to low levels of light, the plant's _____ the cellular organs that generate energy from light-reshuffled to form a tightly packed, glass-like surface ideal for collecting more light.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. chloroplasts
- B. chloroplasts;
- C. chloroplasts,
- D. chloroplasts-

CORRECT_ANSWER: D

RATIONALE:

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is the punctuation of a supplementary element within a sentence. The dash after "chloroplasts" pairs with the dash after "from light" to separate the supplementary element "the cellular organs that generate energy from light" from the rest of the sentence. This supplementary element functions to define the term "chloroplasts," and the pair of dashes indicates that this element could be removed without affecting the grammatical coherence of the sentence.

Choice A is incorrect because it fails to use appropriate punctuation to separate the supplementary element from the rest of the sentence.

Choice B is incorrect because a semicolon can't be paired with a dash in this way to separate the supplementary element from the rest of the sentence. Choice C is incorrect because a comma can't be paired with a dash in this way to separate the supplementary element from the rest of the sentence.

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is the punctuation of a supplementary element within a sentence. The dash after "chloroplasts" pairs with the dash after "from light" to separate the supplementary element "the cellular organs that generate energy from light" from the rest of the sentence. This supplementary element functions to define the term "chloroplasts," and the pair of dashes indicates that this element could be removed without affecting the grammatical coherence of the sentence.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 74ce2f05

SOURCE_FILE: Boundaries.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 7

SKILL: Boundaries

DIFFICULTY: Medium

QUESTION:

A study led by scientist Rebecca Kirby at the University of Wisconsin-Madison found that black bears that eat human food before hibernation have increased levels of a rare carbon isotope, _____ due to the higher ¹³C levels in corn and cane sugar. Bears with these elevated levels were also found to have much shorter hibernation periods on average. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. carbon-13, (¹³C)
- B. carbon-13 (¹³C)
- C. carbon-13, (¹³C),
- D. carbon-13 (¹³C),

CORRECT_ANSWER: D

RATIONALE:

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is the punctuation of a supplementary element within a sentence. The comma after "(¹³C)" pairs with the comma after "isotope" to separate the supplementary element "carbon-13 (¹³C)" from the rest of the sentence. This supplementary element defines the "rare carbon isotope," and the pair of commas indicates that this element could be removed without affecting the grammatical coherence of the sentence. Choice A is incorrect because it fails to use appropriate punctuation to separate the supplementary element "carbon-13 (¹³C)" from the rest of the sentence. Choice B is incorrect because it fails to use appropriate punctuation to separate the supplementary element "carbon-13 (¹³C)" from the rest of the sentence. Choice C is incorrect because it fails to use appropriate punctuation to separate the supplementary element "carbon-13 (¹³C)" from the rest of the sentence. The comma after "carbon-13" isn't necessary because the parentheses around "¹³C" already separate this element from the rest of the sentence.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: a7c85001

SOURCE_FILE: Boundaries.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 8

SKILL: Boundaries

DIFFICULTY: Easy

QUESTION:

Researchers Amit Kumar and Nicholas Epley investigated how _____. In a series of experiments conducted in 2022, they found that people performing small acts of kindness underestimated the positive effect their actions had on others. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. do people perceive acts of kindness.
- B. do people perceive acts of kindness?
- C. people perceive acts of kindness?
- D. people perceive acts of kindness.

CORRECT_ANSWER: D

RATIONALE:

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is end-of-sentence punctuation. This choice correctly uses a period to punctuate a declarative sentence that asks an indirect question ("Researchers Amit Kumar and Nicholas Epley investigated how people perceive acts of kindness").

Choice A is incorrect. The structure of the sentence requires a declarative clause at the end of the sentence that states what Kumar and Epley

did, not an interrogative clause that asks a direct question, such as "how do people perceive acts of kindness."

Choice B is incorrect. The

structure of the sentence requires a declarative clause at the end of the sentence that states what Kumar and Epley did, not an interrogative

clause that asks a direct question, such as "how do people perceive acts of kindness?" Choice C is incorrect. It's unconventional to use a

question mark in this way to punctuate a declarative sentence that asks an indirect question, such as "Researchers...kindness."

"

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: eb95235b

SOURCE_FILE: Boundaries.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 9

SKILL: Boundaries

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

The Limón technique, developed by Mexican-born dancer and choreographer Jose Limón, is known for its emphasis on breath control and its interplay of weight and _____ dancers may explore, for example, the moment of mid-air suspension at the top of a jump.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. weightlessness
- B. weightlessness which
- C. weightlessness,
- D. weightlessness;

CORRECT_ANSWER: D

RATIONALE:

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of punctuation within a sentence. This choice uses a semicolon in a conventional way to join the first main clause ("The Limón...weightlessness") and the second main clause ("dancers...jump").

Choice A is incorrect because it results in a run-on sentence. The two main clauses are fused without punctuation and/or a conjunction. Choice

B is incorrect. The relative pronoun "which" can't be used in this way to join two main clauses. Choice C is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. Without a conjunction following it, a comma can't be used in this way to join two main clauses.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: adf210e7

SOURCE_FILE: Boundaries.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 10

SKILL: Boundaries

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

The haiku-like poems of Tomas Tranströmer, which present nature- and dream-influenced images in crisp, spare language, have earned the Swedish poet praise from leading contemporary _____ them Nigerian American essayist and novelist Teju Cole, who has written that Tranströmer's works "contain a luminous simplicity."
"

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. writers. Among
- B. writers among
- C. writers; among
- D. writers, among

CORRECT_ANSWER: D

RATIONALE:

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is punctuation use between a main clause and a supplementary phrase. This choice correctly uses a comma to mark the boundary between the main clause ("The haiku-like...writers") and the supplementary phrase ("among...Cole") that specifies a contemporary writer who has praised Tomas Tranströmer's haiku-like poems. Choice A is incorrect because it results in a rhetorically unacceptable sentence fragment beginning with "among." Choice B is incorrect because it fails to mark the boundary between the main clause and the supplementary phrase with appropriate punctuation. Choice C is incorrect because a semicolon can't be used in this way to join the main clause ("The haiku-like...writers") and the supplementary phrase ("among...Cole").

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 707461d8

SOURCE_FILE: Boundaries.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 11

SKILL: Boundaries

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

In 2021, Mexican biologist Martha Lydia Macías-Rubalcava led a review of the scientific literature related to endophytic fungi (i.e., fungi that live inside a host _____ researching 120 endophytic fungi-produced compounds, she found that their phytotoxicity can make them viable alternatives to chemical herbicides for controlling weeds.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. plant). By
- B. plant), by
- C. plant) and by
- D. plant) by

CORRECT_ANSWER: A

RATIONALE:

Choice A is the best answer. The convention being tested is punctuation use between sentences. In this choice, the period is used correctly to mark the boundary between one sentence ("In...plant") and another ("By...weeds"). The prepositional phrase beginning with "by" modifies the subject of the next sentence, "she," which refers to Macías-Rubalcava.

Choice B is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. A comma can't be used in this way to join two sentences. Choice C is incorrect.

Without a comma preceding it, the conjunction "and" can't be used in this way to join two sentences. Choice D is incorrect because it results in a run-on sentence. The two sentences are fused without punctuation and/or a conjunction.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 13fcf575

SOURCE_FILE: Boundaries.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 12

SKILL: Boundaries

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

Roughly 300 nights a year, when the cold air descending from the Andes Mountains meets the warm air rising from Venezuela's coastal Lake Maracaibo, the result is a spectacular lightning storm, its strikes so bright, so localized, and so _____ that it has become known as "Maracaibo's Lighthouse."
"

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. dependable:
- B. dependable;
- C. dependable
- D. dependable,

CORRECT_ANSWER: C

RATIONALE:

Choice C is the best answer. The convention being tested is the punctuation of an integrated relative clause. No punctuation is needed before the relative clause beginning with "that" because the content of the relative clause ("that...Lighthouse") is integral to the meaning of the coordinated adjectival phrase ("so bright, so localized, and so dependable") that it modifies. Choice A is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the coordinated adjectival phrase ("so bright...dependable") and the integrated relative clause that modifies it. Choice B is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the coordinated adjectival phrase ("so bright...dependable") and the integrated relative clause that modifies it. Choice D is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the coordinated adjectival phrase ("so bright...dependable") and the integrated relative clause that modifies it.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 940ff6f7

SOURCE_FILE: Boundaries.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 13

SKILL: Boundaries

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

Jamaican British artist Willard Wigan is known for his remarkable _____ so small that they are best viewed through a microscope, Wigan's sculptures are made from tiny natural materials, such as spiderweb strands.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. microsculptures creations
- B. microsculptures, creations
- C. microsculptures. Creations
- D. microsculptures and creations

CORRECT_ANSWER: C

RATIONALE:

Choice C is the best answer. The convention being tested is punctuation between sentences. In this choice, the period is used to correctly mark the boundary between one sentence ("Jamaican...microsculptures") and another ("Creations...strands"). The noun phrase beginning with "creations" modifies the subject of the next sentence, "Wigan's sculptures."

Choice A is incorrect because it results in a run-on sentence. The sentences ("Jamaican...microsculptures" and "Creations...strands") are fused without punctuation and/or a conjunction. Choice B is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. A comma can't be used in this way to mark the boundary between sentences. Choice D is incorrect. Without a comma preceding it, the conjunction "and" can't be used in this way to join sentences.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 333b2b65

SOURCE_FILE: Boundaries.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 14

SKILL: Boundaries

DIFFICULTY: Medium

QUESTION:

While one requires oxygen and one does _____ and anaerobic respiration are both forms of cellular respiration-that is, they are processes by which cells break down glucose to use as energy.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. not aerobic
- B. not. Aerobic
- C. not, aerobic
- D. not; aerobic

CORRECT_ANSWER: C

RATIONALE:

Choice C is the best answer. A comma is the appropriate way to link the dependent clause "While...not" and the independent clause that follows.

Choice A is incorrect. This choice creates a run-on sentence error. "While...not" is a dependent clause, which must be separated from the independent clause that follows with some sort of punctuation. Choice B is incorrect. This choice creates a sentence fragment. "While one

requires oxygen and one does not" isn't an independent clause, so it can't stand alone as a complete sentence.

Choice D is incorrect. This choice

creates a punctuation error. "While one requires oxygen and one does not" isn't an independent clause, so it can't be linked to the clause that follows with a semicolon.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: aaa1907f

SOURCE_FILE: Boundaries.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 15

SKILL: Boundaries

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

To serve local families during the Great Depression, innovative New York City librarian Pura Belpré offered storytelling in both English and Spanish, an uncommon _____ celebrated el Día de los Tres Reyes Magos, an important community holiday; and put on puppet shows dramatizing Puerto Rican folktales.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. practice, at the time
- B. practice at the time;
- C. practice, at the time,
- D. practice at the time,

CORRECT_ANSWER: B

RATIONALE:

Choice B is the best answer. The convention being tested is the punctuation of elements in a complex series. It's conventional to use a semicolon to separate items in a complex series with internal punctuation, and in this choice, the semicolon after "time" is conventionally used to separate the first item ("offered...time") and the second ("celebrated...holiday") in the series of activities that librarian Pura Belpré offered.

Moreover, the semicolon after "time" matches the semicolon used later to separate the second item ("celebrated...holiday") and the third ("and...folktales") in the series.

Choice A is incorrect because it fails to use appropriate punctuation to separate the first item and the second item in the complex series.

Furthermore, a comma isn't needed between the noun "practice" and the prepositional phrase "at the time" because the prepositional phrase is essential to the full meaning of the phrase "an uncommon practice at the time."

Choice C is incorrect because a comma after "time" doesn't match the semicolon used later to separate the second ("celebrated...holiday") and third ("and...folktales") items in the series. Furthermore, a

comma isn't needed between the noun "practice" and the prepositional phrase "at the time" because the prepositional phrase is essential to the full meaning of the phrase "an uncommon practice at the time."

Choice D is incorrect because a comma after "time" doesn't match the semicolon used later to separate the second ("celebrated...holiday") and third ("and...folktales") items in the series.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 7f48b098

SOURCE_FILE: Boundaries.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 16

SKILL: Boundaries

DIFFICULTY: Medium

QUESTION:

Photosynthesis, the mechanism by which plants use sunlight to turn carbon dioxide and water into _____ is fueled in part by an enzyme called Photosystem II that harvests energy-giving electrons from water molecules. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. nutrients
- B. nutrients and
- C. nutrients,
- D. nutrients-

CORRECT_ANSWER: C

RATIONALE:

Choice C is the best answer. The convention being tested is the punctuation of a supplementary element within a sentence. The comma after "nutrients" pairs with the comma after "photosynthesis" to separate the supplementary element "the mechanism by which plants use sunlight to turn carbon dioxide and water into nutrients" from the rest of the sentence. This supplementary element functions to define the term "photosynthesis," and the pair of commas indicates that this element could be removed without affecting the grammatical coherence of the sentence.

Choice A is incorrect because it fails to use appropriate punctuation to separate the supplementary element from the rest of the sentence.

Choice B is incorrect because a conjunction can't be paired with a comma in this way to separate the supplementary element from the rest of the sentence.

Choice D is incorrect because a dash can't be paired with a comma in this way to separate the supplementary element from the rest of the sentence.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 626a1642

SOURCE_FILE: Boundaries.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 17

SKILL: Boundaries

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

As a behavioral economist, Katy Milkman of the University of Pennsylvania recognizes that people sometimes make irrational economic decisions. Milkman's research can thus address anomalies that neoclassical economic _____ assume that people are consistently rational decision-makers-cannot explain.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. models-which
- B. models, which
- C. models which
- D. models which-

CORRECT_ANSWER: A

RATIONALE:

Choice A is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of punctuation within a sentence. The dashes after "models" and "decision-makers" correctly separate the supplementary element "which assume that people are consistently rational decision-makers" from the rest of the sentence. This punctuation indicates that this element could be removed without affecting the grammatical coherence of the sentence.

Choice B is incorrect because a comma can't be paired with a dash in this way to separate the supplementary element from the rest of the sentence. Choice C is incorrect because it fails to use appropriate punctuation to separate the supplementary element from the rest of the sentence. Choice D is incorrect because it interrupts the sentence at an illogical and grammatically incoherent point. The dash should be placed before "which," not after it, to mark the beginning of the supplementary element.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 148be4da

SOURCE_FILE: Boundaries.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 18

SKILL: Boundaries

DIFFICULTY: Easy

QUESTION:

Human-made (synthetic) fibers used in clothes and many other consumer products are more durable than most natural plant _____ the manufacture of synthetic fibers requires toxic chemical solvents that can pollute air and water. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. fibers,
- B. fibers but
- C. fibers
- D. fibers, but

CORRECT_ANSWER: D

RATIONALE:

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is the coordination of main clauses within a sentence. This choice correctly uses a comma and the coordinating conjunction "but" to join the first main clause ("Human-made...fibers") and the second main clause ("the manufacture...water"). Choice A is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. Without a conjunction following it, a comma can't be used in this way to join two main clauses. Choice B is incorrect because when coordinating two longer main clauses such as these, it's conventional to use a comma before the coordinating conjunction. Choice C is incorrect because it results in a run-on sentence. The two main clauses are fused without punctuation and/or a conjunction.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 0f39b19c

SOURCE_FILE: Boundaries.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 19

SKILL: Boundaries

DIFFICULTY: Medium

QUESTION:

After a spate of illnesses as a child, Wilma Rudolph was told she might never walk again. Defying all odds, Rudolph didn't just walk, she _____ the 1960 Summer Olympics in Rome, she won both the 100- and 200-meter dashes and clinched first place for her team in the 4x100-meter relay, becoming the first US woman to win three gold medals in a single Olympics. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. ran-fast-during
- B. ran-fast during
- C. ran-fast, during
- D. ran-fast. During

CORRECT_ANSWER: D

RATIONALE:

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is punctuation use between sentences. In this choice, the period is used correctly to mark the boundary between one sentence ("Defying...fast") and another sentence that begins with a supplementary phrase ("During...Olympics"). Choice A is incorrect. When a dash is present in a sentence ("ran-fast"), it's not conventional to use another dash ("fast-during") to mark the boundary between sentences because it creates a potentially confusing sentence. In this context, a period, semicolon, or colon would be clear and more conventional. Choice B is incorrect because it results in a run-on sentence. The sentences ("Defying...fast") and ("during...Olympics") are fused without punctuation and/or a conjunction. Choice C is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. A comma can't be used in this way to mark the boundary between sentences.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: f78997cf

SOURCE_FILE: Boundaries.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 20

SKILL: Boundaries

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

Recent analysis of 32532 Thereus-an outer solar system object orbiting the Sun between Jupiter and Saturn-has determined its color to be gray, suggesting an icy composition. Such interpretations are ultimately _____ the object's gray coloration may be an incidental effect of radiation, solar wind, or collisions with other objects rather than evidence of its physical makeup. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. speculative, though
- B. speculative, though;
- C. speculative; though
- D. speculative, though,

CORRECT_ANSWER: B

RATIONALE:

Choice B is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of punctuation in a sentence. This choice correctly uses a comma to separate the supplementary adverb "though" from the preceding main clause ("Such interpretations are ultimately speculative") and uses a semicolon to join the next main clause ("the object's...makeup") to the rest of the sentence. Further, placing the semicolon after "though" indicates that the information in the preceding main clause (interpretations of an outer solar system object's composition based on its color are ultimately speculative) is a qualification of the information in the previous sentence (the composition of an outer solar system object is suggested by its color). Choice A is incorrect because it fails to mark the boundary between the two main clauses with appropriate punctuation. Choice C is incorrect because placing the semicolon after "speculative" illogically indicates that the information in the next main clause ("the object's...makeup") is a qualification of the information in the previous clause ("Such...speculative"). Choice D is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. Commas can't be used in this way to punctuate a supplementary word or phrase between two main clauses.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 4dcedc31

SOURCE_FILE: Boundaries.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 21

SKILL: Boundaries

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

For scientists to produce new iron nanoparticles of a specific size or strength, they must first be able to monitor reactions between oxygen and existing iron nanoparticles at a near-atomic level of detail. Fortunately, chemistry _____ and his colleagues at Temple University recently developed a new approach that does just that.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. professor Yugang Sun
- B. professor Yugang Sun,
- C. professor, Yugang Sun,
- D. professor, Yugang Sun

CORRECT_ANSWER: A

RATIONALE:

Choice A is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of punctuation between titles and proper nouns. No punctuation is needed between the proper noun "Yugang Sun" and the title that describes Sun, "chemistry professor." Furthermore, no punctuation is needed after "Sun" because "chemistry professor Yugang Sun and his colleagues at Temple University" functions as the coordinated subject of the sentence, and together Sun and colleagues performed the action of developing a new approach to producing iron nanoparticles. Choice B is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the proper noun "Yugang Sun" and the coordinated noun phrase "and his colleagues at Temple University." Choice C is incorrect because no punctuation is needed before or after the proper noun "Yugang Sun." Setting off the professor's name with commas suggests that it could be removed without affecting the coherence of the sentence, which isn't the case. Choice D is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the title "chemistry professor" and the proper noun "Yugang Sun."

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 155239cf

SOURCE_FILE: Boundaries.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 22

SKILL: Boundaries

DIFFICULTY: Easy

QUESTION:

By analyzing ice cores from Greenland and Antarctica, a research team at Sweden's Lund University discovered evidence of a solar storm that occurred 9,200 years ago. Scientists had previously thought the Sun to be in a relatively "quiet" phase at that _____ the Lund team's finding suggests otherwise.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. time but
- B. time, but
- C. time,
- D. time

CORRECT_ANSWER: B

RATIONALE:

Choice B is the best answer. The convention being tested is the coordination of main clauses within a sentence. This choice correctly uses a comma and the coordinating conjunction "but" to join the first main clause ("Scientists...time") and the second main clause ("the Lund...otherwise").

Choice A is incorrect because when coordinating two longer main clauses such as these, it's conventional to use a comma before the coordinating conjunction. Choice C is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. Without a conjunction following it, a comma can't be used in this way to join two main clauses. Choice D is incorrect because it results in a run-on sentence. The two main clauses are fused without punctuation and/or a conjunction.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 82a76537

SOURCE_FILE: Boundaries.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 23

SKILL: Boundaries

DIFFICULTY: Medium

QUESTION:

Key-value pairs are an important aspect of JavaScript Object Notation (JSON), an electronic file format for storing and transmitting data. Keys function as labels, while values contain the actual information. In a JSON file storing data about fire belly _____ instance, you could encounter a key such as "species" with the associated value of "Cynops orientalis."

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. newts. For
- B. newts, for
- C. newts: for
- D. newts; for

CORRECT_ANSWER: B

RATIONALE:

Choice B is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of punctuation within a sentence. The comma after "newts" pairs with the comma after "instance" to separate the supplementary element "for instance" from the rest of the sentence. The supplementary element appears between the prepositional phrase ("In...newts") and the main clause of the sentence ("you...orientalis") and signals that the sentence is presenting an example of how keys and values function in JSON files. Choice A is incorrect because it results in a sentence fragment ("In a JSON file storing data about fire belly newts"). Choice C is incorrect because a colon can't be paired with a comma in this way to separate the supplementary element "for instance" from the rest of the sentence. Choice D is incorrect because a semicolon can't be paired with a comma in this way to separate the supplementary element "for instance" from the rest of the sentence.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: e2f77ae7

SOURCE_FILE: Boundaries.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 24

SKILL: Boundaries

DIFFICULTY: Medium

QUESTION:

That Chaucer's Canterbury Tales inspired imitators is evident from the existence of three near-contemporary "continuations" of the collection: The Siege of Thebes, which purports to be a new tale told during the pilgrims' _____ The Tale of Beryn, which depicts the pilgrims as tourists; and The Ploughman's Tale, which features a minor character from the original work. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. return.
- B. return
- C. return;
- D. return,

CORRECT_ANSWER: C

RATIONALE:

Choice C is the best answer. The convention being tested is the punctuation of elements in a complex series. It's conventional to use a semicolon to separate items in a complex series with internal punctuation, and in this choice, the semicolon after "return" is conventionally used to separate the first item ("The Siege of Thebes...return") and the second item ("The Tale of Beryn...tourists") in the series of tales. Moreover, the semicolon after "return" matches the semicolon used later to separate the second item and the third item ("and The Ploughman's Tale...work") in the series.

Choice A is incorrect because placing a period after "return" results in a rhetorically unacceptable sentence fragment beginning with "The Tale of Beryn."

Choice B is incorrect because it fails to use appropriate punctuation to separate the first item and the second item in the complex series.

Choice D is incorrect because a comma after "return" doesn't match the semicolon used later to separate the second and third items in the series.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 9091458d

SOURCE_FILE: Boundaries.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 25

SKILL: Boundaries

DIFFICULTY: Easy

QUESTION:

Emperor penguins don't waddle out of the ocean. They launch themselves at such a high speed that they travel up to two meters before landing.

How _____ A layer of microbubbles on their plumage reduces friction as the penguins speed to the surface.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. they are able to move so fast!
- B. are they able to move so fast.
- C. they are able to move so fast.
- D. are they able to move so fast?

CORRECT_ANSWER: D

RATIONALE:

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is end-of-sentence punctuation. This choice correctly uses a question mark to punctuate the interrogative sentence "how are they able to move so fast?" The interrogative sentence asks a direct question, and the next sentence answers it.

Choice A is incorrect because the context requires an interrogative sentence. The exclamative sentence "how they are able to move so fast!"

emphasizes the penguin's high rate of speed, but it doesn't set up the next sentence's explanation of how the penguins achieve such speeds.

Choice B is incorrect because a period can't be used in this way to punctuate an interrogative sentence. Choice C is incorrect because the

context requires an interrogative sentence. The exclamative sentence "how they are able to move so fast" emphasizes the penguin's high rate of

speed, but it doesn't set up the next sentence's explanation of how the penguins achieve such speeds.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: ac5536c1

SOURCE_FILE: Boundaries.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 26

SKILL: Boundaries

DIFFICULTY: Medium

QUESTION:

Beatrix Potter is perhaps best known for writing and illustrating children's books such as *The Tale of Peter Rabbit* (1902), but she also dedicated herself to mycology, the study of _____ more than 350 paintings of the fungal species she observed in nature and submitting her research on spore germination to the Linnean Society of London.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. fungi; producing
- B. fungi. Producing
- C. fungi producing
- D. fungi, producing

CORRECT_ANSWER: D

RATIONALE:

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is punctuation use between two supplementary phrases following the coordinate clause ("but she...mycology"). This choice correctly uses a comma to mark the boundary between the supplementary noun phrase ("the study of fungi") that defines the term "mycology" and the supplementary participial phrase ("producing...London") that provides additional information about the extent to which Potter dedicated herself to mycology.

Choice A is incorrect because a semicolon can't be used in this way to join two supplementary phrases following a coordinate clause. Choice B is incorrect because it results in a rhetorically unacceptable sentence fragment beginning with "producing." Choice C is incorrect. The lack of punctuation results in a sentence that illogically suggests that the study of fungi is producing more than 350 paintings.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 5bed774c

SOURCE_FILE: Boundaries.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 27

SKILL: Boundaries

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

Philosopher Peter Kivy was a leading figure in musical _____ evidenced by his belief that instead of evoking particular emotions, such as sadness or joy, compositions elicit a listener's emotional response to the structure and artistry of the music itself. Kivy's approach to the study of music was decidedly formalist.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. aesthetics as
- B. aesthetics and as
- C. aesthetics, as
- D. aesthetics. As

CORRECT_ANSWER: D

RATIONALE:

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is punctuation use between sentences. In this choice, the period is used correctly to mark the boundary between one sentence ("Philosopher...aesthetics") and another ("As...formalist"). The long adverbial element "as evidenced...itself" modifies the content in the following clause to support the claim that Kivy's approach was formalist.

Choice A is incorrect because it results in a run-on sentence. The sentences ("Philosopher...aesthetics" and "As...formalist") are fused without punctuation and/or a conjunction. Choice B is incorrect. Without a comma preceding it, the conjunction "and" can't be used in this way to join sentences. Choice C is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. A comma can't be used in this way to mark the boundary between sentences.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 9c3630b9

SOURCE_FILE: Boundaries.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 28

SKILL: Boundaries

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

Using natural debris, such as dried _____ such as plastic bags; and more traditional art supplies, such as tree glue, Ghanaian artist Ed Franklin

Gavua creates his striking Yiiiikakaii African masks, which he hopes can help viewers rethink how waste is used in their communities.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. leaves, man-made trash:
- B. leaves; man-made trash,
- C. leaves, man-made trash,
- D. leaves; man-made trash;

CORRECT_ANSWER: B

RATIONALE:

Choice B is the best answer. The convention being tested is the punctuation of elements in a complex series. It's conventional to use a semicolon to separate items in a complex series with internal punctuation, and in this choice, the semicolon after "leaves" is conventionally used to separate the first item ("natural debris, such as dried leaves") and the second item ("man-made trash, such as plastic bags") in the series of materials used by Gavua. Further, the comma after "trash" correctly separates the noun phrase "man-made trash" from the supplementary phrase ("such as plastic bags") that describes it.

Choice A is incorrect because a comma after "leaves" doesn't match the semicolon used later to separate the second and third items in the series ("man-made...bags" and "and...glue"). Additionally, it's not conventional to use a colon in this way to separate a supplementary phrase ("such as plastic bags") from the noun phrase it modifies ("man-made trash"). Choice C is incorrect because a comma after "leaves" doesn't match the semicolon used later to separate the second and third items in the series ("man-made...bags" and "and...glue"). Choice D is incorrect because it's not conventional to use a semicolon in this way to separate a supplementary phrase ("such as plastic bags") from the noun phrase it modifies ("man-made trash").

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 3a2d77d7

SOURCE_FILE: Boundaries.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 29

SKILL: Boundaries

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

In the 1950s, novel audio technologies allowed the addition of another instrument to jazz and swing _____ relatively quiet instrument, its full range of sound was finally audible alongside the blaring brass instruments of the time, allowing flautists like Bennie Maupin and Bobbi Humphrey to perform with other jazz greats. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. music, the flute, a
- B. music. The flute, a
- C. music; the flute, a
- D. music: the flute. A

CORRECT_ANSWER: D

RATIONALE:

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of punctuation within and between sentences. In this choice, the colon correctly introduces the name of the instrument (the flute) that novel audio technologies allowed to be added to jazz and swing. In addition, the period is used to correctly mark the boundary between one sentence ("In...flute") and another ("A relatively...greats"). Choice A is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. A comma can't be used in this way to join two main clauses ("In...quiet instrument" and "its...greats"). Choice B is incorrect. In standard English, it's unconventional to form a sentence in this way with two uncoordinated subjects ("the flute" and "its full range of sound"), and the lack of a clear main subject results in an awkwardly constructed and confusing sentence. Choice C is incorrect. In standard English, it's unconventional to form an independent clause in this way with two uncoordinated subjects ("the flute" and "its full range of sound"), and the lack of a clear main subject results in an awkwardly constructed and confusing clause.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 435809d8

SOURCE_FILE: Boundaries.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 30

SKILL: Boundaries

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

On March 23, 2021, a gust of wind wreaked havoc on global trade. Ever Given, an international shipping container vessel, became lodged in Egypt's Suez Canal, a major shipping route between Europe and Asia. The vessel took six days to _____ it's as heavy as two thousand blue whales when fully loaded.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. dislodge in par t due to its sheer size,
- B. dislodge, in par t due to its sheer size:
- C. dislodge, in par t due to its sheer size,
- D. dislodge, in par t, due to its sheer size

CORRECT_ANSWER: B

RATIONALE:

Choice B is the best answer. The convention being tested is punctuation between main clauses and a supplementary element. This choice correctly uses a comma to mark the boundary between the main clause ("The vessel took six days to dislodge") and the supplementary element

("in par t due to its sheer size") that provides additional information on why the vessel was difficult to dislodge. Additionally, this choice correctly uses a colon to introduce another main clause that describes the vessel's size ("it's as heavy as two thousand blue whales when fully loaded").

Choice A is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. A comma can't be used in this way to mark the boundary between two main clauses

("The vessel...size" and "it's...loaded"). Additionally, it fails to mark the boundary between the main clause ("The vessel took six days to dislodge")

and the supplementary element ("in par t due to its sheer size"). Choice C is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. A comma can't be

used in this way to mark the boundary between two main clauses ("The vessel...size" and "it's...loaded"). Choice D is incorrect because it results

in a run-on sentence. The two main clauses ("The vessel...size" and "it's...loaded") are fused without punctuation and/or a conjunction.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: e38b3e4f

SOURCE_FILE: Form, Structure, and Sense.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 1

SKILL: Form, Structure, and Sense

DIFFICULTY: Easy

QUESTION:

The radiation that _____ during the decay of radioactive atomic nuclei is known as gamma radiation. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. occurs
- B. have occurred
- C. occur
- D. are occurring

CORRECT_ANSWER: A

RATIONALE:

Choice A is the best answer. The convention being tested is subject-verb agreement. The singular verb "occurs" agrees in number with the singular subject "radiation."

Choice B is incorrect because the plural verb "have occurred" doesn't agree in number with the singular subject "radiation."

" Choice C is incorrect because the plural verb "occur" doesn't agree in number with the singular subject "radiation."

" Choice D is incorrect because the plural verb "are occurring" doesn't agree in number with the singular subject "radiation."

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 37e5c794

SOURCE_FILE: Form, Structure, and Sense.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 2

SKILL: Form, Structure, and Sense

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

Despite being cheap, versatile, and easy to produce, _____ they are made from nonrenewable petroleum, and most do not biodegrade in landfills.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. there are two problems associated with commercial plastics:
- B. two problems are associated with commercial plastics:
- C. commercial plastics' two associated problems are that
- D. commercial plastics have two associated problems:

CORRECT_ANSWER: D

RATIONALE:

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is subject-modifier placement. This choice ensures that the modifying phrase "despite being cheap, versatile, and easy to produce" appears immediately before the noun it modifies, "commercial plastics,"

" clearly establishing that the commercial plastics-and not another noun in the sentence-are being described as cheap, versatile, and easy to produce.

Choice A is incorrect because it results in a dangling modifier. The placement of the function word "there" immediately after the modifying phrase illogically and confusingly suggests that "there" is cheap, versatile, and easy to produce. Choice B is incorrect because it results in a dangling modifier. The placement of the noun "two problems" immediately after the modifying phrase illogically suggests that the "problems" are cheap, versatile, and easy to produce. Choice C is incorrect because it results in a dangling modifier. The placement of the noun phrase "commercial plastics' two associated problems" immediately after the modifying phrase illogically suggests that the "problems" are cheap, versatile, and easy to produce.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 6f08641e

SOURCE_FILE: Form, Structure, and Sense.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 3

SKILL: Form, Structure, and Sense

DIFFICULTY: Medium

QUESTION:

On April 5, 1977, Kitty Cone and 150 other disability rights activists entered a San Francisco federal building. After pleading for years-to no effect-for the passage of key antidiscrimination legislation, _____ until their demands were addressed. Finally, on April 28, the legislation was signed.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. pressure on lawmakers increased when the activists staged a sit-in protest
- B. a sit-in protest staged by the activists increased pressure on lawmakers
- C. lawmakers came under increased pressure when the activists staged a sit-in protest
- D. the activists increased pressure on lawmakers by staging a sit-in protest

CORRECT_ANSWER: D

RATIONALE:

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is subject-modifier placement. This choice makes the noun phrase "the activists" the subject of the sentence and places it immediately after the modifying phrase "after...legislation."

In doing so, this choice clearly establishes that the activists-and not another noun in the sentence-were pleading for the passage of antidiscrimination legislation.

Choice A is incorrect because it results in a dangling modifier. The placement of the noun phrase "pressure on lawmakers" immediately after the modifying phrase illogically suggests that the "pressure" was pleading for the passage of antidiscrimination legislation. Choice B is incorrect

because it results in a dangling modifier. The placement of the noun phrase "a sit-in protest" immediately after the modifying phrase illogically suggests that the "protest" was pleading for the passage of antidiscrimination legislation. Choice C is incorrect because it results in a dangling

modifier. The placement of the noun phrase "lawmakers" immediately after the modifying phrase suggests that "lawmakers" were pleading for

the passage of antidiscrimination legislation. While it's possible for lawmakers to plead for the passage of legislation, the context strongly

suggests that it's the activists who pleaded for years for the passage of antidiscrimination legislation.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 3a1239d2

SOURCE_FILE: Form, Structure, and Sense.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 4

SKILL: Form, Structure, and Sense

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

If an animal can recognize itself in a reflective surface ("the mirror test"), it is considered to have self-awareness. In a recent study, scientists _____ for evidence of self-awareness in snakes, species that rely primarily on olfactory rather than visual processing, adapted the test to foreground smell, modifying the scent trails of North American eastern garter snakes and African ball pythons.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. searched
- B. searching
- C. were searching
- D. have searched

CORRECT_ANSWER: B

RATIONALE:

Choice B is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of verb forms within a sentence. The nonfinite present participle "searching" is correctly used to form a supplementary element that modifies the subject "scientists," indicating that the scientists who adapted the test were looking for evidence of self-awareness in snakes.

Choice A is incorrect because it results in an ungrammatical sentence. The finite past tense verb "searched" can't be used in this way to form a supplementary element that indicates what evidence the scientists who adapted the test were looking for. Choice C is incorrect because it results in an ungrammatical sentence. The finite past progressive verb "were searching" can't be used in this way to form a supplementary element that indicates what evidence the scientists who adapted the test were looking for. Choice D is incorrect because it results in an ungrammatical sentence. The finite present perfect verb "have searched" can't be used in this way to form a supplementary element that indicates what evidence the scientists who adapted the test were looking for.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 3580533b

SOURCE_FILE: Form, Structure, and Sense.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 5

SKILL: Form, Structure, and Sense

DIFFICULTY: Easy

QUESTION:

In recent years, economists around the world have created new tools that quantify the overall well-being of a country's citizens. Economists in India, for example, use an Ease of Living Index. This tool _____ economic potential, sustainability, and citizens' quality of life.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. measures
- B. had measured
- C. would have measured
- D. will have been measuring

CORRECT_ANSWER: A

RATIONALE:

Choice A is the best answer. The previous sentence tells us how economists in India "use" a certain tool, while this sentence describes general facts about that tool. To express general facts (and also to match the simple present tense of "use"), we should use the simple present tense form "measures."

Choice B is incorrect. This choice uses the past perfect tense, but the previous sentence tells us that the tool is currently used to measure things, so the past tense doesn't make sense for this verb. Choice C is incorrect. This choice uses the future perfect conditional tense, but the previous sentence tells us that the tool is currently used to measure things, so the future tense doesn't make sense for this verb. Choice D is incorrect. This choice uses the future perfect continuous tense, but the previous sentence tells us that the tool is currently used to measure things, so the future tense doesn't make sense for this verb.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 2c49940e

SOURCE_FILE: Form, Structure, and Sense.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 6

SKILL: Form, Structure, and Sense

DIFFICULTY: Medium

QUESTION:

French philosopher René Descartes doubted whether he could prove his own existence. Eventually, he found proof in his famous phrase "I think, therefore I am."

" The _____ complexity: only those who exist would be able to ponder their existence. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. phrases' simplicity masks its
- B. phrases simplicity masks their
- C. phrase's simplicity masks their
- D. phrase's simplicity masks its

CORRECT_ANSWER: D

RATIONALE:

Choice D is the best answer. The conventions being tested are the use of possessive nouns and the use of possessive determiners. The singular possessive noun "phrase's" correctly indicates that there is only one simple phrase. The singular possessive determiner "its" agrees in number with the singular possessive noun "phrase's," reinforcing the idea that there is only one simple yet complex phrase. Choice A is incorrect because the context requires the singular possessive noun "phrase's," not the plural possessive noun "phrases'." Choice B is incorrect because the context requires the singular possessive noun "phrase's" and the corresponding singular possessive determiner "its," not the plural noun "phrases" and the corresponding plural possessive determiner "their." Choice C is incorrect because the context requires the singular possessive determiner "its," not the plural possessive determiner "their."

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: e62241b7

SOURCE_FILE: Form, Structure, and Sense.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 7

SKILL: Form, Structure, and Sense

DIFFICULTY: Easy

QUESTION:

What is the correct pronunciation of Kiribati? In the Gilbertese language spoken by residents of the island nation, the letter combination -ti makes the -s sound; as a result, the country's name _____ pronounced "Kiribas."
"

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. are
- B. have been
- C. are being
- D. is

CORRECT_ANSWER: D

RATIONALE:

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is subject-verb agreement. The singular verb "is" agrees in number with the singular subject "the country's name."
"

Choice A is incorrect because the plural verb "are" doesn't agree in number with the singular subject "the country's name."

" Choice B is incorrect

because the plural verb "have been" doesn't agree in number with the singular subject "the country's name."

" Choice C is incorrect because the

plural verb "are being" doesn't agree in number with the singular subject "the country's name."

"

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: a2816c7f

SOURCE_FILE: Form, Structure, and Sense.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 8

SKILL: Form, Structure, and Sense

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

American abstract artist Richard _____ his installations to make passersby keenly aware of how one's movements are affected by the physical features of one's environment, assembles large-scale steel plates into sculptures that dominate the outdoor spaces they occupy. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. Serra is intending
- B. Serra, intends
- C. Serra, intending
- D. Serra intends

CORRECT_ANSWER: C

RATIONALE:

Choice C is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of verb forms within a sentence. This choice pairs the comma after "Serra" with the comma after "environment" and uses the nonfinite present participle "intending" to correctly form a supplementary phrase describing the reaction Serra intends his sculptures to provoke. This supplementary phrase appears between the noun phrase that it modifies ("American abstract artist Richard Serra") and the finite present tense verb ("assembles"), which functions as the sentence's main verb and describes what Serra does.

Choice A is incorrect because it results in an ungrammatical sentence. The finite present continuous tense verb "is intending" can't be used in this way in conjunction with the finite present tense verb "assembles," which already functions as the main verb in the sentence. Choice B is incorrect because it results in an ungrammatical sentence. The finite present tense verb "intends" can't be used in this way to supplement the noun phrase "American abstract artist Richard Serra."

Choice D is incorrect because it results in an ungrammatical sentence. The finite present tense verb "intends" can't be used in this way in conjunction with the finite present tense verb "assembles," which already functions as the main verb in the sentence.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: b7363ba2

SOURCE_FILE: Form, Structure, and Sense.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 9

SKILL: Form, Structure, and Sense

DIFFICULTY: Easy

QUESTION:

Mathematician and meteorologist Edward Lorenz used the metaphor of the "butterfly effect" to explain how seemingly minor events can have major impacts on future weather. According to Lorenz's metaphor, the wind from a butterfly flapping _____ in Brazil might eventually grow into a storm elsewhere across the globe.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. its wings
- B. its wings'
- C. it's wing's
- D. it's wings'

CORRECT_ANSWER: A

RATIONALE:

Choice A is the best answer. The conventions being tested are the use of possessive determiners and plural nouns. The singular possessive

determiner "its" and the plural noun "wings" correctly indicate that the butterfly has multiple wings.

Choice B is incorrect because the context requires the plural noun "wings,

" not the plural possessive noun "wings'.

" Choice C is incorrect because

the context requires the singular possessive determiner "its" and the plural noun "wings,

" not the contraction "it's" and the singular possessive

noun "wing's.

" Choice D is incorrect because the context requires the singular possessive determiner "its" and the plural noun "wings,

" not the

contraction "it's" and the plural possessive noun "wings'.

"

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 908a76b8

SOURCE_FILE: Form, Structure, and Sense.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 10

SKILL: Form, Structure, and Sense

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

When a given industry-water and electricity are two well-known examples-carries high infrastructural start-up costs and other barriers that discourage competition, _____ of just one or two suppliers per municipality. Such industries are known as natural monopolies.
Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. these often consist
- B. they often consist
- C. it often consists
- D. this often consists

CORRECT_ANSWER: C

RATIONALE:

Choice C is the best answer. The convention being tested is pronoun-antecedent agreement. The singular pronoun "it" agrees in number with the singular antecedent "industry" and clearly indicates that the industry consists of just one or two suppliers per municipality.
Choice A is incorrect. The plural pronoun "these" neither agrees in number with the singular antecedent "industry" nor clearly indicates that the industry-not another plural noun in the sentence, such as "start-up costs" or "barriers"-consists of just one or two suppliers per municipality.
Choice B is incorrect because the plural pronoun "they" doesn't agree in number with the singular antecedent "industry."
Choice D is incorrect because the singular pronoun "this" is ambiguous in this context; the resulting sentence leaves unclear what consists of just one or two suppliers per municipality.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 1ee7b429

SOURCE_FILE: Form, Structure, and Sense.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 11

SKILL: Form, Structure, and Sense

DIFFICULTY: Medium

QUESTION:

Bonnie Buratti of NASA's Jet Propulsion Laboratory _____ data about Saturn's rings collected by the Cassini spacecraft when she made an interesting discovery: the tiny moons embedded between and within Saturn's rings are shaped by the buildup of ring material on the moons' surfaces.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. studies
- B. has been studying
- C. will study
- D. was studying

CORRECT_ANSWER: D

RATIONALE:

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of verbs to express tense in a sentence. In this choice, the past progressive tense verb "was studying" is consistent with the other past tense verbs (e.g., "made" and "collected") used to describe Buratti's discovery. Further, the past progressive tense correctly indicates that an ongoing action in the past was occurring (she was studying) at the same time that another event occurred in the past (she made an interesting discovery).

Choice A is incorrect because the present tense verb "studies" isn't consistent with the past tense verbs used to describe Buratti's discovery.

Choice B is incorrect because the present perfect progressive tense verb "has been studying" isn't consistent with the past tense verbs used to describe Buratti's discovery. Choice C is incorrect because the future tense verb "will study" isn't consistent with the past tense verbs used to describe Buratti's discovery.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 4c335aea

SOURCE_FILE: Form, Structure, and Sense.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 12

SKILL: Form, Structure, and Sense

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

In a recent analysis of lyrical trends in 350,000 songs, researchers cite increases in certain measures, such as the ratio of choruses to verses, as evidence music lyrics are becoming more repetitive. For instance, from 1970 to 2020, _____ chorus-to-verse ratios trended similarly, with each genre's data indicating that relative to the number of unique verses, the number of repeated choruses in songs increased.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. rocks and raps
- B. rock's and rap's
- C. rocks and rap's
- D. rock and rap's

CORRECT_ANSWER: B

RATIONALE:

Choice B is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of possessive nouns. The singular possessive nouns "rock's" and "rap's"

correctly indicate that the chorus-to-verse ratios belong to the genres of rock and rap.

Choice A is incorrect because the context requires the singular possessive nouns "rock's" and "rap's," not the plural nouns "rocks" and "raps."

Choice C is incorrect because the context requires the singular possessive noun "rock's," not the plural noun "rocks."

Choice D is incorrect because the context requires the singular possessive noun "rock's," not the singular noun "rock."

This choice incorrectly suggests that there was a single chorus-to-verse ratio for rock and rap together, whereas the ratio was calculated for each genre individually.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 8b017d4e

SOURCE_FILE: Form, Structure, and Sense.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 13

SKILL: Form, Structure, and Sense

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

Supported by biochemical analyses of over 2,000 skeletons from the Middle Ages, _____
Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. vegetables and grains were, a 2022 study found, the primary components of early medieval rulers' diets.
- B. early medieval rulers' diets were found, in a 2022 study, to have primarily consisted of vegetables and grains.
- C. the primary components of early medieval rulers' diets were vegetables and grains, according to a 2022 study.
- D. findings from a 2022 study suggested that vegetables and grains were the primary components of early medieval rulers' diets.

CORRECT_ANSWER: D

RATIONALE:

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is subject-modifier placement. This choice makes the noun phrase "findings from a 2022 study" the subject of the sentence and places it immediately after the modifying phrase "supported...Ages." In doing so, this choice clearly establishes that the findings-and not another noun in the sentence-are supported by the biochemical analyses. Choice A is incorrect because it results in a dangling modifier. The placement of "vegetables and grains" immediately after the modifying phrase illogically suggests that vegetables and grains are supported by biochemical analyses. Choice B is incorrect because it results in a dangling modifier. The placement of "early medieval rulers' diets" immediately after the modifying phrase illogically suggests that the rulers' diets are supported by biochemical analyses. Choice C is incorrect because it results in a dangling modifier. The placement of "the primary components" immediately after the modifying phrase illogically suggests that the primary components are supported by biochemical analyses.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 9127635a

SOURCE_FILE: Form, Structure, and Sense.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 14

SKILL: Form, Structure, and Sense

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

Star actress Kiki Omeili, who has appeared in 47 Nollywood films, is one of numerous luminaries to be pictured in Nigerian portraitist Iké Udé's exhibition Nollywood Portraits. _____ referred to Nollywood-Nigeria's \$3 billion film industry-as "Africa's vivid mirror par excellence, " honors its legacy with his vivid classical portraits of Omeili and her peers. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. Udé, has
- B. Udé has
- C. Udé
- D. Udé, having

CORRECT_ANSWER: D

RATIONALE:

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of verb forms and punctuation within a sentence. The sentence's subject is "Udé, " and its finite main verb is "honors." This choice correctly uses the nonfinite participle "having referred" to form a supplementary element ("having...excellence") describing Udé. The comma after "Udé" appropriately marks the boundary before that supplementary element. Choice A is incorrect because using the finite verb "has referred" creates an ungrammatical sentence. The sentence already has the finite main verb "honors, " so "has referred" can't also function as a second main verb here without additional punctuation or conjunctions. Moreover, no punctuation is needed when a subject ("Udé") is immediately followed by a finite verb ("has referred"). Choice B is incorrect because using the finite verb "has referred" creates an ungrammatical sentence. The sentence already has the finite main verb "honors, " so "has referred" can't also function as a second main verb here without additional punctuation or conjunctions. Choice C is incorrect because using the finite verb "referred" creates an ungrammatical sentence. The sentence already has the finite main verb "honors, " so "referred" can't also function as a second main verb here without additional punctuation or conjunctions.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 36e89f74

SOURCE_FILE: Form, Structure, and Sense.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 15

SKILL: Form, Structure, and Sense

DIFFICULTY: Easy

QUESTION:

An imposing spire of igneous rock rising high above the Belle Fourche River in eastern Wyoming, Devils Tower (also known as Bear Lodge) is one of the most prominent examples of columnar jointing, a pattern of fracturing in rocks that _____ in parallel arrays of long polygonal prisms. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. resulting
- B. were resulting
- C. results
- D. to result

CORRECT_ANSWER: C

RATIONALE:

Choice C is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of verb forms within a sentence. Relative clauses, such as the one beginning with "that," require a finite (tensed) verb, a verb that can function as the main verb of a clause. This choice correctly supplies the clause with the finite present tense verb "results." Furthermore, the simple present tense verb "results" correctly indicates that the formation of parallel arrays of long polygonal prisms is an enduring property of this fracturing pattern. Choice A is incorrect because it results in an ungrammatical sentence. The nonfinite participle "resulting" doesn't supply the clause with a finite verb. Choice B is incorrect because the past progressive tense verb "were resulting" doesn't indicate that the formation of parallel arrays of long polygonal prisms is an enduring property of this fracturing pattern. Choice D is incorrect because it results in an ungrammatical sentence. The nonfinite to-infinitive "to result" doesn't supply the clause with a finite verb.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 035fd57e

SOURCE_FILE: Form, Structure, and Sense.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 16

SKILL: Form, Structure, and Sense

DIFFICULTY: Easy

QUESTION:

The rough frog is a species of amphibian native to Australia. Currently, the frog's range _____ parts of northern New South Wales and southeastern Queensland.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. includes
- B. included
- C. will have included
- D. had included

CORRECT_ANSWER: A

RATIONALE:

Choice A is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of verbs to express tense in a sentence. In this choice, the present tense verb

"includes,

" used in conjunction with the word "currently,

" correctly indicates that the frog's current range includes parts of northern New South Wales and southeastern Queensland.

Choice B is incorrect because the past tense verb "included" doesn't indicate that the frog's range currently includes parts of northern New South

Wales and southeastern Queensland. Choice C is incorrect because the future perfect tense "will have included" doesn't indicate that the frog's

range currently includes parts of northern New South Wales and southeastern Queensland. Choice D is incorrect because the past perfect tense

"had included" doesn't indicate that the frog's range currently includes parts of northern New South Wales and southeastern Queensland.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 9df6da04

SOURCE_FILE: Form, Structure, and Sense.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 17

SKILL: Form, Structure, and Sense

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

Entomologists Yash Sondhi and Samuel Fabian have tried to explain why moths fly erratically around light sources at night. Knowing that flying insects keep their backs pointed toward sunlight during the day, _____
Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. the researchers theorize that moths, mistaking nighttime lights for the Sun, continually try to reorient their bodies while flying near such lights.
- B. the researchers' theory is that moths mistake nighttime lights for the Sun, continually trying to reorient their bodies while flying near such lights.
- C. moths mistake nighttime lights for the Sun and continually try to reorient their bodies while flying near such lights, the researchers theorize.
- D. moths continually try to reorient their bodies while flying near nighttime lights, the researchers theorize, mistaking such lights for the Sun.

CORRECT_ANSWER: A

RATIONALE:

Choice A is the best answer. The convention being tested is subject-modifier placement. This choice makes the noun phrase "the researchers" the subject of the sentence and places it immediately after the modifying phrase "knowing...day." In doing so, this choice clearly establishes that the researchers-and not another noun in the sentence-know that flying insects keep their backs pointed toward sunlight during the day. Choice B is incorrect because it results in a dangling modifier. The placement of the noun phrase "the researchers' theory" immediately after the modifying phrase illogically suggests that the researchers' theory knows that flying insects keep their backs pointed toward sunlight during the day. Choice C is incorrect because it results in a dangling modifier. The placement of the noun "moths" immediately after the modifying phrase illogically suggests that moths know that flying insects keep their backs pointed toward sunlight during the day. Choice D is incorrect because it results in a dangling modifier. The placement of the noun "moths" immediately after the modifying phrase illogically suggests that moths know that flying insects keep their backs pointed toward sunlight during the day.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: ae439895

SOURCE_FILE: Form, Structure, and Sense.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 18

SKILL: Form, Structure, and Sense

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

In her 1983 book *The Managed Heart: Commercialization of Human Feeling*, sociologist Arlie Russell Hochschild first explored at length her conception of a "sociology of emotions"-the idea that the various cultural and ideological frameworks a person has internalized (class, gender, political affiliation, etc.) _____ each emotional reaction that person has within a situation. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. underlies
- B. is underlying
- C. underlie
- D. has been underlying

CORRECT_ANSWER: C

RATIONALE:

Choice C is the best answer. The convention being tested is subject-verb agreement. The plural verb "underlie" agrees in number with the plural subject "frameworks."

Choice A is incorrect because the singular verb "underlies" doesn't agree in number with the plural subject "frameworks."

Choice B is incorrect

because the singular verb "is underlying" doesn't agree in number with the plural subject "frameworks."

Choice D is incorrect because the singular verb "has been underlying" doesn't agree in number with the plural subject "frameworks."

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 83617355

SOURCE_FILE: Form, Structure, and Sense.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 19

SKILL: Form, Structure, and Sense

DIFFICULTY: Easy

QUESTION:

Each night in Gijón, Spain, a section of the city's marina is bathed in a soft green glow. The source of the glow is the Árbol de la Sidra, a large sculpture made up of 3,200 recycled glass bottles. A lamp inside the tree-shaped structure _____ the green glass.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. will be illuminating
- B. illuminates
- C. would illuminate
- D. illuminated

CORRECT_ANSWER: B

RATIONALE:

Choice B is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of verbs to express tense. In this choice, the present tense verb "illuminates" is consistent with the other present tense verb ("is") used to describe the sculpture, correctly indicating that the sculpture habitually glows ("each night") and that the lamp inside is the source of its illumination.

Choice A is incorrect because the future progressive tense verb "will be illuminating" isn't consistent with the other present tense verb used to describe the sculpture and the source of its glow. Choice C is incorrect because the modal "would," which is used to indicate a typical behavior in the past, isn't consistent with the other present tense verb used to describe the sculpture and the source of its glow. Choice D is incorrect because the past tense verb "illuminated" isn't consistent with the other present tense verb used to describe the sculpture and the source of its glow.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 16740ab4

SOURCE_FILE: Form, Structure, and Sense.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 20

SKILL: Form, Structure, and Sense

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

At the Chicxulub asteroid impact crater in Mexico, the presence of many fossilized microbacteria, which seem to have thrived there despite the extreme heat that persisted after the Chicxulub impact, _____ claims that bacteria are among the planet's most resilient organisms.
Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. have reinforced
- B. reinforces
- C. are reinforcing
- D. reinforce

CORRECT_ANSWER: B

RATIONALE:

Choice B is the best answer. The convention being tested is subject-verb agreement. The singular verb "reinforces" agrees in number with the singular subject "the presence."

Choice A is incorrect because the plural verb "have reinforced" doesn't agree in number with the singular subject "the presence."

" Choice C is incorrect because the plural verb "are reinforcing" doesn't agree in number with the singular subject "the presence."

" Choice D is incorrect because the plural verb "reinforce" doesn't agree in number with the singular subject "the presence."

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: f0864217

SOURCE_FILE: Form, Structure, and Sense.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 21

SKILL: Form, Structure, and Sense

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

Rabinal Achí is a precolonial Maya dance drama performed annually in Rabinal, a town in the Guatemalan highlands. Based on events that occurred when Rabinal was a city-state ruled by a king, _____ had once been an ally of the king but was later captured while leading an invading force against him.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. Rabinal Achí tells the story of K'iche' Achí, a military leader who
- B. K'iche' Achí, the military leader in the story of Rabinal Achí,
- C. the military leader whose story is told in Rabinal Achí, K'iche' Achí,
- D. there was a military leader, K'iche' Achí, who in Rabinal Achí

CORRECT_ANSWER: A

RATIONALE:

Choice A is the best answer. The modifier "Based on events...by a king," is describing the drama "Rabinal Achí."

Modifiers need to be next to the subjects they describe, so "Rabinal Achí" needs to be the first word after the comma.

Choice B is incorrect. This doesn't complete the text in a way that conforms to the conventions of Standard English. The modifier "Based on events...by a king,"

is describing the drama "Rabinal Achí."

Modifiers need to be next to the subjects they describe, so "Rabinal Achí" needs to be the first word after the comma. Choice C is incorrect. This doesn't complete the text in a way that conforms to the conventions of Standard

English. The modifier "Based on events...by a king,"

is describing the drama "Rabinal Achí."

Modifiers need to be next to the subjects they

describe, so "Rabinal Achí" needs to be the first word after the comma. Choice D is incorrect. This doesn't complete the text in a way that

conforms to the conventions of Standard English. The modifier "Based on events...by a king,"

is describing the drama "Rabinal Achí."

Modifiers

need to be next to the subjects they describe, so "Rabinal Achí" needs to be the first word after the comma.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: c91ef0f0

SOURCE_FILE: Form, Structure, and Sense.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 22

SKILL: Form, Structure, and Sense

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

During the American Civil War, Thomas Morris Chester braved the front lines as a war correspondent for the Philadelphia Press. Amplifying the voices and experiences of Black soldiers _____ of particular importance to Chester, who later became an activist and lawyer during the postwar Reconstruction period.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. were
- B. have been
- C. are
- D. was

CORRECT_ANSWER: D

RATIONALE:

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is subject-verb agreement. The singular verb "was" agrees in number with the singular subject "amplifying."

" Gerunds such as "amplifying" are always singular.

Choice A is incorrect because the plural verb "were" doesn't agree in number with the singular subject "amplifying."

" Choice B is incorrect because the plural verb "have been" doesn't agree in number with the singular subject "amplifying."

" Choice C is incorrect because the plural verb "are" doesn't agree in number with the singular subject "amplifying."

"

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 7b419faf

SOURCE_FILE: Form, Structure, and Sense.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 23

SKILL: Form, Structure, and Sense

DIFFICULTY: Easy

QUESTION:

In 1903, environmentalist John Muir guided President Theodore Roosevelt on a scenic, sprawling trip through California's Yosemite Valley. Upon returning from the three-day excursion, Roosevelt _____ to conserve the nation's wilderness areas, a vow he upheld for his remaining six years in office.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. is vowing
- B. vowed
- C. will vow
- D. vows

CORRECT_ANSWER: B

RATIONALE:

Choice B is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of verbs to express tense in a sentence. In this choice, the past tense verb

"vowed" is consistent with the other past tense verbs ("guided" and "upheld") used to narrate the events surrounding President Roosevelt's decision to conserve the nation's wilderness areas.

Choice A is incorrect because the present progressive tense verb "is vowing" isn't consistent with the past tense verbs used to narrate the events

surrounding President Roosevelt's decision to conserve the nation's wilderness areas. Choice C is incorrect because the future tense verb "will

vow" isn't consistent with the past tense verbs used to narrate the events surrounding President Roosevelt's decision to conserve the nation's

wilderness areas. Choice D is incorrect because the simple present tense verb "vows" isn't consistent with the past tense verbs used to

narrate the events surrounding President Roosevelt's decision to conserve the nation's wilderness areas.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 29c9be28

SOURCE_FILE: Form, Structure, and Sense.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 24

SKILL: Form, Structure, and Sense

DIFFICULTY: Easy

QUESTION:

To survive when water is scarce, embryos inside African turquoise killifish eggs _____ a dormant state known as diapause. In this state, embryonic development is paused for as long as two years-longer than the life span of an adult killifish. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. enter
- B. to enter
- C. having entered
- D. entering

CORRECT_ANSWER: A

RATIONALE:

Choice A is the best answer. The convention being tested is finite and nonfinite verb forms within a sentence. A main clause requires a finite verb to perform the action of the subject (in this case, "embryos"), and this choice supplies the clause with the finite present tense verb "enter" to indicate how the embryos achieve diapause. Choice B is incorrect because the nonfinite to-infinitive "to enter" doesn't supply the main clause with a finite verb. Choice C is incorrect because the nonfinite participle "having entered" doesn't supply the main clause with a finite verb. Choice D is incorrect because the nonfinite participle "entering" doesn't supply the main clause with a finite verb.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 983d33fa

SOURCE_FILE: Form, Structure, and Sense.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 25

SKILL: Form, Structure, and Sense

DIFFICULTY: Easy

QUESTION:

In 1637, the price of tulips skyrocketed in Amsterdam, with single bulbs of rare varieties selling for up to the equivalent of \$200,000 in today's US dollars. Some historians _____ that this "tulip mania" was the first historical instance of an asset bubble, which occurs when investors drive prices to highs not supported by actual demand. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. claiming
- B. claim
- C. having claimed
- D. to claim

CORRECT_ANSWER: B

RATIONALE:

Choice B is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of finite and nonfinite verb forms within a sentence. A main clause requires a finite verb to perform the action of the subject (in this case, "some historians"), and this choice supplies the finite present tense verb "claim" to indicate what some historians do. Choice A is incorrect because the nonfinite participle "claiming" doesn't supply the main clause with a finite verb. Choice C is incorrect because the nonfinite participle "having claimed" doesn't supply the main clause with a finite verb. Choice D is incorrect because the nonfinite to-infinitive "to claim" doesn't supply the main clause with a finite verb.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 6e193b19

SOURCE_FILE: Form, Structure, and Sense.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 26

SKILL: Form, Structure, and Sense

DIFFICULTY: Medium

QUESTION:

Professional American football player Fred Cox invented one of the world's most popular toys. In the 1970s, he came up with the idea for the Nerf football, which _____ of the harder and heavier regulation football.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. were a smaller, foam version
- B. are smaller, foam versions
- C. were smaller, foam versions
- D. is a smaller, foam version

CORRECT_ANSWER: D

RATIONALE:

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is subject-verb agreement and agreement between nouns. The singular verb "is" and

the singular noun "version" both agree in number with the relative pronoun "which."

" In this context, "which" functions as a singular subject because it refers to the singular noun "the Nerf football."

Choice A is incorrect because the plural verb "were" doesn't agree in number with the singular noun phrase "the Nerf football" that it's modifying.

Choice B is incorrect because the plural verb "are" and the plural noun "versions" don't agree in number with the singular noun phrase "the Nerf

football" that they're modifying. Choice C is incorrect because the plural verb "were" and the plural noun "versions" don't agree in number with the

singular noun phrase "the Nerf football" that they're modifying.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: fced396a

SOURCE_FILE: Form, Structure, and Sense.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 27

SKILL: Form, Structure, and Sense

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

The Herfindahl-Hirschman Index (HHI), a commonly used measure of competition between companies in a particular market, ranges from a score of zero to 10,000 points. Compared with that of a highly concentrated market-that is, a market controlled by very few companies-_____ Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. a market that is less concentrated will have a much lower HHI score.
- B. the HHI score of a less concentrated market will be much lower.
- C. when a market is less concentrated, its HHI score will be much lower.
- D. a less concentrated market will have an HHI score that is much lower.

CORRECT_ANSWER: B

RATIONALE:

Choice B is the best answer. The convention being tested is subject-modifier placement. This choice makes the noun phrase "the HHI...market" the subject of the sentence and places it immediately after the modifying phrase "compared...market." In doing so, this choice clearly establishes that the HHI score of a less concentrated market-and not another noun in the sentence-is being compared with the HHI score of a highly concentrated market. Choice A is incorrect because it results in a dangling modifier. The placement of "a market that is less concentrated" immediately after the modifying phrase illogically suggests that a market is being compared with an HHI score. Choice C is incorrect because it results in a confusing, illogical sentence. The placement of the modifier "when a market is less concentrated" after "a highly concentrated market" is contradictory. Furthermore, it's ambiguous what "its" is referring to in "its HHI score," resulting in an illogical comparison. Choice D is incorrect because it results in a dangling modifier. The placement of "a less concentrated market" immediately after the modifying phrase illogically suggests that a market is being compared with an HHI score.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: e6f2dba6

SOURCE_FILE: Form, Structure, and Sense.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 28

SKILL: Form, Structure, and Sense

DIFFICULTY: Easy

QUESTION:

According to the traditional RYB (red-yellow-blue) color model, yellow is a complementary color to purple. However, yellow _____ considered complementary to blue in modern color theory.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. is
- B. having been
- C. to be
- D. being

CORRECT_ANSWER: A

RATIONALE:

Choice A is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of verb forms within a sentence. A main clause requires a finite (tensed) verb to perform the action of the subject (in this case, "yellow"), and this choice supplies the present tense verb "is considered" to indicate that yellow is considered a complementary color to blue in modern color theory.

Choice B is incorrect because it results in an ungrammatical sentence. The nonfinite participle "having been considered" doesn't supply the main clause with a finite verb. Choice C is incorrect because it results in an ungrammatical sentence. The nonfinite to-infinitive "to be considered" doesn't supply the main clause with a finite verb. Choice D is incorrect because it results in an ungrammatical sentence. The nonfinite participle "being considered" doesn't supply the main clause with a finite verb.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 52b61716

SOURCE_FILE: Form, Structure, and Sense.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 29

SKILL: Form, Structure, and Sense

DIFFICULTY: Easy

QUESTION:

Formed in 1967 to foster political and economic stability within the Asia-Pacific region, the Association of Southeast Asian Nations was originally made up of five members: Thailand, the Philippines, Singapore, Malaysia, and Indonesia. By the end of the 1990s, the organization _____ its initial membership.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. has doubled
- B. had doubled
- C. doubles
- D. will double

CORRECT_ANSWER: B

RATIONALE:

Choice B is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of verbs to express tense. In this choice, the past perfect verb "had doubled" properly indicates that the doubling of the organization's initial membership occurred during a specific period before the present (between the organization's founding in 1967 and the end of the 1990s).

Choice A is incorrect because the present perfect verb "has doubled" doesn't indicate that the organization's doubling of its initial membership occurred during a specific period in the past. Choice C is incorrect because the present tense verb "doubles" doesn't indicate that the organization's doubling of its initial membership occurred during a specific period in the past. Choice D is incorrect because the future tense verb "will double" doesn't indicate that the organization's doubling of its initial membership occurred during a specific period in the past.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 96c720af

SOURCE_FILE: Form, Structure, and Sense.pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 30

SKILL: Form, Structure, and Sense

DIFFICULTY: Easy

QUESTION:

Atoms in a synchrotron, a type of circular particle accelerator, travel faster and faster until they _____ a desired energy level, at which point they are diverted to collide with a target, smashing the atoms.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- A. will reach
- B. reach
- C. had reached
- D. are reaching

CORRECT_ANSWER: B

RATIONALE:

Choice B is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of verbs to express tense in a sentence. In this choice, the present tense verb "reach" is consistent with the present tense verbs "travel" and "are diverted" used to describe how atoms move through the synchrotron.

Choice A is incorrect because the future tense verb "will reach" is inconsistent with the present tense verbs used to describe how atoms move through the synchrotron. Though the atoms' movement is a recurring action and "will reach" can also be used to indicate a habitual or recurring action, it creates a logical inconsistency in this sentence when paired with the present tense verbs "travel" and "are diverted".

Choice C is incorrect because the past perfect tense verb "had reached" is inconsistent with the present tense verbs used to describe how atoms move through the synchrotron. Choice D is incorrect because the present progressive tense verb "are reaching" is inconsistent with the present tense verbs used to describe how atoms move through the synchrotron. While both verbs occur in the present, the present progressive tense suggests that the action is currently in progress. This creates a logical inconsistency when paired with the present tense verbs "travel" and "are diverted",

which offer a general description of the tendencies of the atoms' movement, rather than a description of an action that is currently in progress.

END_QUESTION